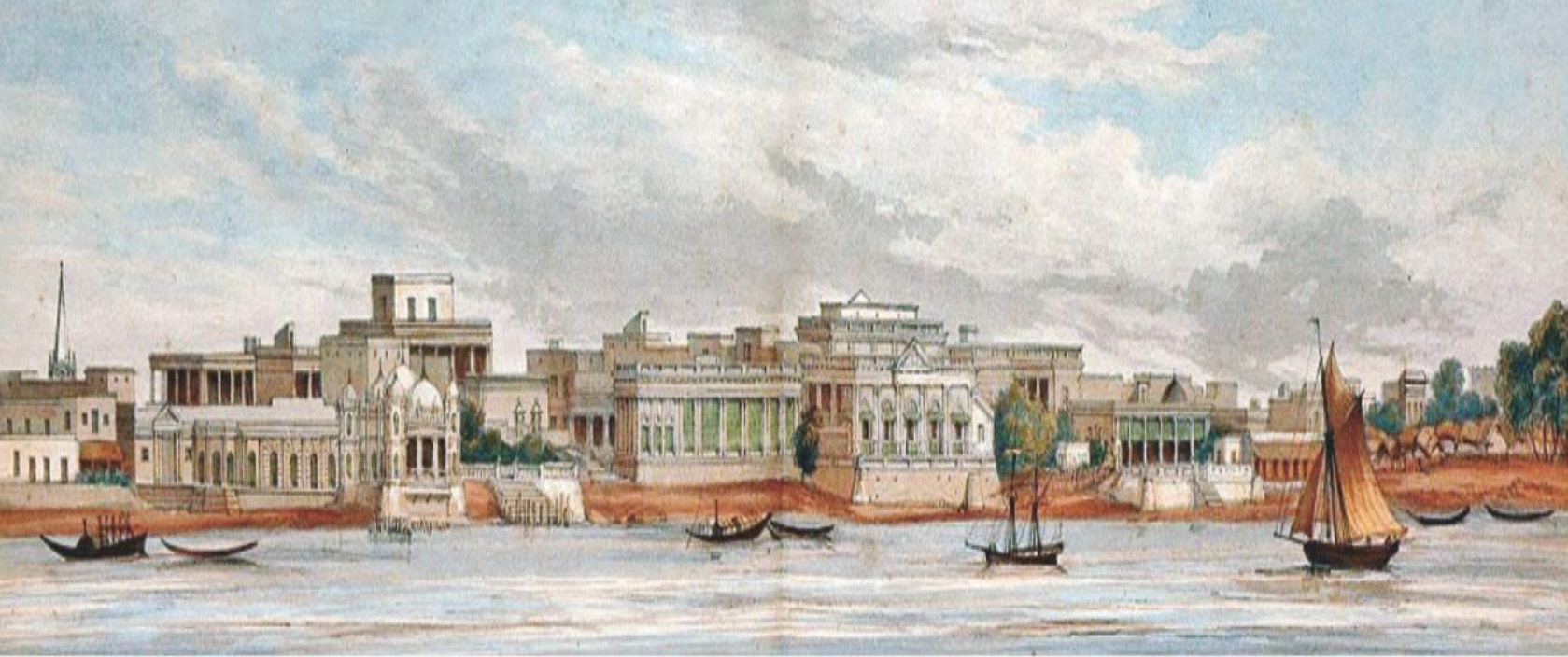




L 6. Central Asian rule in Bengal



BENGAL UNDER CENTRAL ASIAN RULE

TURKO-AFGHAN RULE

Independent Sultanate rule

Mughal Rulers

ANCIENT COINS OF BENGAL



Ancient Period

Ardha-karshapana Punch-marked Coin (Janapada Series)

Provenance

Wari-Bateswar Region, Narsingdi District During the earliest phase of civilization the indigenous coins were being familiar with the people of this land as the Lauhitya Janapada coins were obtained from Wari- Bateswar region of Narsingdi. This Janapada series punch marked 1.9 gm silver made coin was denominated as Ardha-Karshapana.



Ancient Period

Dinara

Kushana Coin

During 1st & early 2nd Century AD, gold coins were introduced in the northern part of Indian Subcontinent. 'Royal Tamghas' (monograms) of kings on coins were the legacy of Kushana numismatics. Kanishka I issued the 7.39 gm gold made coin, 'Dinara'. Reverse of the coin denotes goddess standing to right. Legend in Greek script Ardaksho in the left field and monogram in the right field.



Mughal Period

Rupee

Mughal Coin

The Mughals uniformity and consolidation of the system of coinage throughout the Empire is considered as one of the most significant monetary contributions. The speciality of the mughal designs reflected ornamentation, usage of zodiacal signs, portraits, literary verses and excellent calligraphy. Shahab al-din Shajahan issued the 1119 gm silver made 'Rupee' during 1605-1628 AD. The dimension of the coin is 19.72x 18.72x 4.13 mm and the obverse side denotes La Ilahu Illallah Muhammadur Rasulullah, zarb ... Illahi ...



Coins of the Hindu Rulers of the Muslim Period

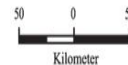
Tanka

Jaintia Coin

Jaintia kings mostly issued coins during the occasion of their accession to the throne. Their issuers are identified on the basis of the date depicted on the coins. Bargosain II (ca. 1731-70 AD) issued the silver made 'Tanka'. The obverse denotes within a circle Sri Sri Si/ va Charana Ka/ mala Madhu Ka/ rasya. Star with five points at end of last line. A musket at the left and a sword at the right field. One countermark; flower presents at the lower left field. Dots in circle before the margin.



HISTORY OF BANGLADESH (BEFORE 1947)



Legend

- Province Boundary
- District Boundary



TURKO-AFGHAN RULE

- Turko-Afghan Rule began in 1204 with Bakhtiyar Khalji overthrowing Lakshman Sena. India or Delhi had been taken over by central Asians expelled by Mongols and others from their land. BK was part of that team.
- Ruling system was military feudalism with chieftains loyal to BK and he was loyal to Delhi. Madrasahs and Central Asian religious institutions like Khanqahs established.
- Many wars of succession and infighting, killing as no dynastic rule existed but of mercenaries.
- Expansion of territories through conquests of the region including Vanga, Bihar, Samatata etc.
- Uneasy relationship with Delhi which included rebellions, conflicts and invasion/ interventions by Delhi forces.
- Invasion of regions like Orissa. (1245) and invaded by others.



ILYAS SHAHI RULE

- Chaos and bloodshed abated a bit after the establishment of independent dynastic Ilyas Shahi rule in Bengal (1338-1538).
- Independence from Delhi led to promotion of local culture. Not choice but necessity.
- Military expansionist policy and growth of kingdom.
- Infighting with others while trade rose. Many external groups came to trade.





CHOTO SONA MOSQUE BUILT DURING THE REIGN OF THE SULTAN OF BENGAL ALAUDDIN HUSAIN SHAH, BETWEEN 1493 AND 1519 LOCATED IN CHAPAI NAWABGANJ DISTRICT OF BANGLADESH.

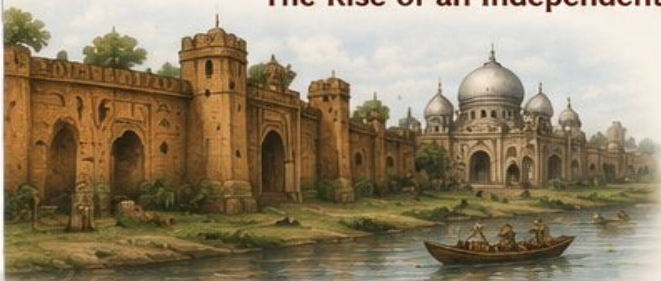
HUSAIN SHAHI RULE

- **Husain Shahi Rule (1494-1538 AD)** began after Alauddin Hussain Shah of Arab origin took power after bloody succession infighting.
- Territorial expansion and fight with Orissa, part of Tripura and capture of Chittagong.
- Avoided membership of anti-Mughal confederacy, and made treaty with Babar, the Mughal, who were ascendant.
- The economic world was opening up. Foreign organized trading. Portuguese arrived as traders and pirates. They built forts and factories at Chittagong for trade, manufacturing and tax collection.
- Sultani rule of Bengal came to an end in 1538 and the next round of chaos began.

ILIJAS SHAHI DYNASTY

1342–1487 AD

The Rise of an Independent Bengali Sultanate



KEY FEATURES

- First stable independent dynasty of Bengal.
- Political unity and territorial expansion.
- Formation of a distinct Muslim administration.
- Flourishing of arts and Bangla literature.
- Appreciation of local people and their participation in administration.
- The whole region came to be known as 'Bangalah'.

IMPORTANT RULERS



Haji Iliyas Shah
(1342–1358)

Founder of the dynasty. Unified Bengal by defeating Ikhtiyaruddin Ghazi Shah of Sonargaon.



Sikandar Shah
(1358–c.1390)

Long and prosperous reign of about 33 years.



Ghiyasuddin Azam Shah
(c.1390)

Capable ruler with profound regard for law.



Nasiruddin Mahmud Shah
(1435–c.1459)

Restored the dynasty after a break during Raja Ganesha's rule.



Ruknuddin Barbak Shah
(c.1459–1474)

Just, liberal and learned. Recruited Abyssinian (Habshi) slaves in large numbers.



Shamsuddin Yusuf Shah
(c.1474–1487)

Applied Sharia law strictly; Ulama ensured its practice in all affairs.

TERRITORIAL EXPANSION



THE END

- Abyssinian (Habshi) slaves became very powerful.
- The last ruler was murdered by one of his slaves in 1487 AD, and the Iliyas Shahi dynasty came to an end.



ACHIEVEMENTS

- Practically the whole of Bengal and parts of west and north-east came under Iliyas Shahi rule.
- Stability, tolerance and enlightened leadership earned the dynasty great popularity.
- Bangla literature and culture flourished under royal patronage.
- Transformation of alien Muslim rule into Bengali Muslim rule began.

HUSAIN SHAHI DYNASTY

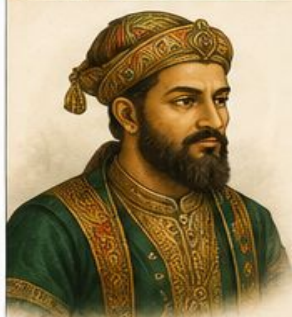
1494–c.1538 AD

An Era of Expansion, Tolerance and Prosperity



KEY FEATURES

- Established by Alauddin Husain Shah after overthrowing the Habshi rulers.
- Territorial expansion in all directions.
- Religious tolerance and liberal policies.
- Patronage of arts, literature and Vaishava movement.
- Contact with the Portuguese and the wider world.



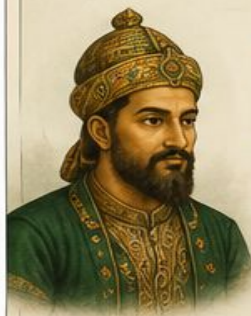
Alauddin Husain Shah (1494–1519)

- Conquered Kamrupa, Kamta and parts of Assam.
- Achieved success against Orissa; titles inscribed on his coins.
- Seized part of Tippera; Chittagong was an important part of his kingdom.
- Known for tolerance – important posts held by Hindus.
- Patronised Bangla Mahabharata (by Kavindra Parameshvara & Shrikara Nandi).
- Offered facilities to Sri Chaitanya; did not impose Jiziyah tax.
- Portuguese mission arrived during his reign.
- Praised by contemporary poet Vijaya Gupta as *Nrpati-tilaka*, *Jagatabhusana* and *Krsna-avatara*.



Coin of Alauddin Husain Shah

SUCCESSOR – NUSRAT SHAH (1519–c.1538)



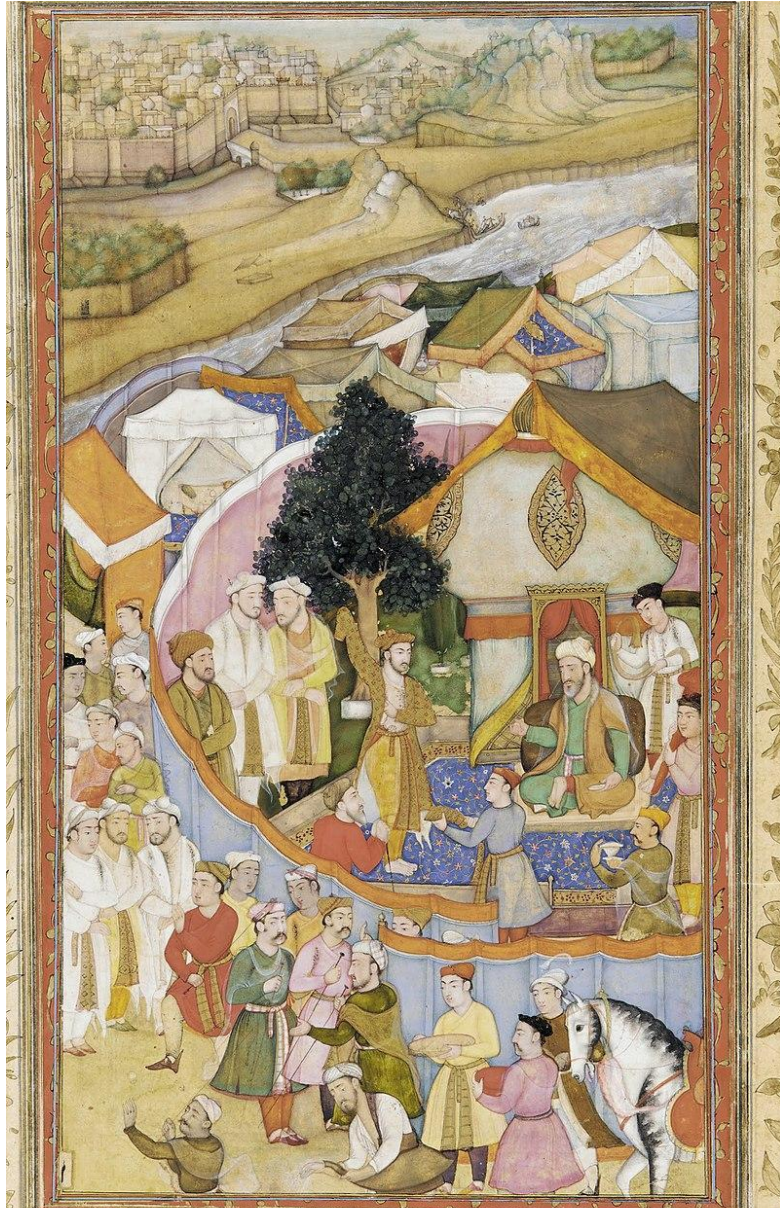
- Expanded territory into Tirhut (North Bihar).
- Maintained neutrality after Babur's victory at Panipat (1526); avoided joining anti-Mughal confederacy.
- Faced battle of Ghogra; made peace with Babur and saved Bengal from future invasions.
- Avoided joining Afghans in the battle of Daurah (1531) in which Humayun defeated Mahmud Lodi.
- Portuguese activity in the Bay of Bengal increased; governors in Chittagong dealt with their 'hazard'.



THE DECLINE

Nusrat Shah was killed by one of his slaves while visiting his father's tomb at Gaur. His successors were weak; governors of distant regions became practically independent. Thus the Husain Shahi rule declined towards the mid-16th century.





SULTAN DAUD KHAN KARRANI RECEIVES A ROBE OF HONOUR FROM MUGHAL GENERAL MUNIM KHAN,AKBAR LEADS HIS ARMY INTO BATTLE AGAINST DAUD KHAN KARRANI,THE LAST SULTAN OF BENGAL



AFGHAN RULE

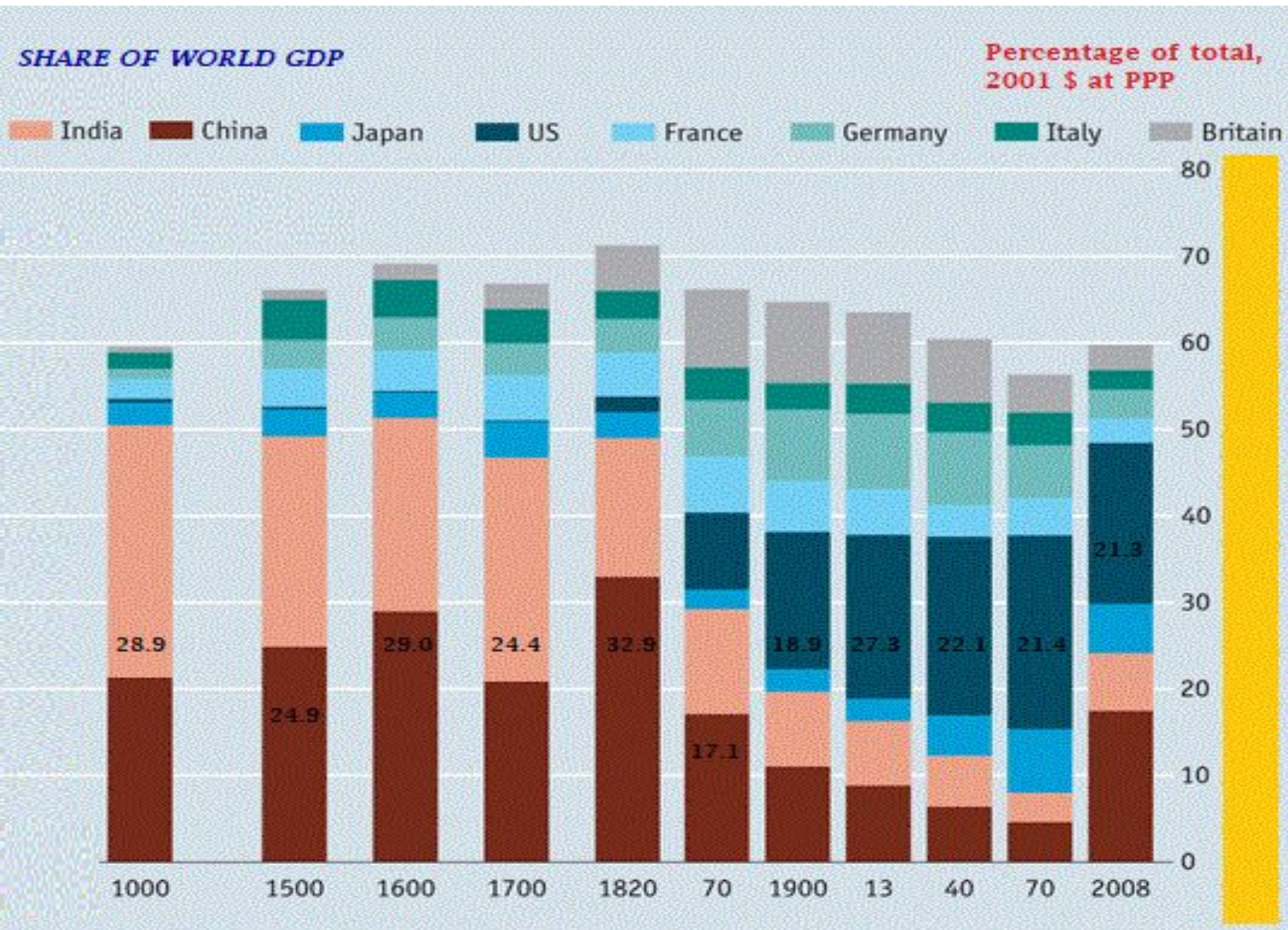
- **Afghan Rule, 1539-1576** started in Bengal in 1539. Afghans were military professionals who served other Bengal kings of that period. Sher Shah was the first Afghan ruler.
- **Bengal under the Sur governors (1539-53 AD)** Good administration and reforms, increased revenue and social project support.
- **Karrani dynasty (1563-76 AD)** . Conquest of Orissa in 1567 AD and Kuch Bihar in 1568 AD. Their defeat ended Afghan rule.



MUGHAL RULE

- Mughal period direct rule was established after 1576. Mughal rule was established in Bengal after the defeat of the Karrani Afghan.
- As the Bengal empire crumbled, many chieftains rebelled, at least 36 of them, who controlled different pockets of Bengal. The Bara Bhuiyans were symbolic of that resistance.
- Shaista Khan's greatest achievement in Bengal was his conquest of Chittagong. The Magh king of Arakan with the help of Portuguese pirates attacked the Mughal province of Bengal whenever he found an opportunity. The Portuguese piracy was a regular threat. So Shaista Khan's conquered Chittagong and made the whole region free from the Arakanese invasions.

BATTLE OF CHITTAGONG IN 1666 BETWEEN THE MUGHALS AND ARAKANESE



ARRIVAL OF COLONIAL RULERS

- Mughal ruler Azim-ush-Shan gave English tax rights and permission to buy Sutanuti, Govindpur and Kalikata in 1698, facilitating the way for establishment of British rule in India.
- Bengal under Murshid Quli Khan, though he paid tributes to Delhi, was practically an independent Nawab. European companies were very strong.
- Maratha raids and other external threats existed.
- Rise of the commercial capitalists in Bengal. Jagat Seth and others. Commerce was always in the hands of outsiders.
- Jagath Sheth family controlled the Bengal money market and had many sympathizers in the rising commercial class.
- English East India Company ignored the Nawab. Conflict ended with the Battle of Plassey.

MUGHAL REVENUE ADMINISTRATION IN BENGAL

A well-designed system of separation of powers to protect imperial interests and those of the people connected with land.

NIZAMAT (General Administration)

Headed by the Nazim / Subahdar

Responsible for defence, warfare, maintenance of peace and general administration.



DIWANI (Revenue Administration)

Headed by the Diwan

Lower in rank than the Subahdar, but independent in financial and revenue matters.

Separation of powers and duties was made to protect imperial interests and those of the raiyats, zamindars, taluqdars.

LAND CLASSIFICATION

KHALSA LAND

Directly administered by the state through the Diwan and his staff.

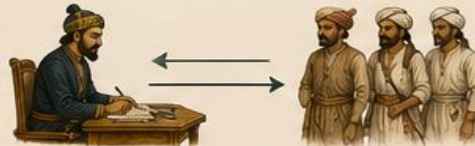
JAGIR LAND

Assigned to officers (civil or military) in lieu of salary for their services.

RELIGIOUS GRANTS

Lands granted for maintenance of religious institutions and to saints, Sufis, etc.

THE ROLE OF ZAMINDARS



Acted as middlemen between the raiyats (cultivators) and the government, collecting revenue and maintaining order.

SOCIAL, CULTURAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE CHANGES UNDER MUGHAL RULE



• **Arrival of People**
Scholars, Ulema, poets, physicians, merchants from various countries came in larger numbers, including Shia scholars and officials.



• **Persian Language**
Persian became the official language. It influenced Bengali language and literature; many Persian words entered Bengali.



• **Administration**
Revenue service became more elaborate; locals like zamindars, muqaddams, patwaris learned Persian for record-keeping.



• **Hindus in High Offices**
Higher revenue posts eventually passed into the hands of Hindus from the time of Murshid Quli Khan.



One law, one official language, uniform administration and currency united Bengal with the Mughal Empire.

TRADE, COMMERCE AND THE ROAD TO PLASSEY

BOOMING TRADE AND PROSPERITY

- Bengal became one of the wealthiest provinces of the Mughal Empire.
- Exports: fine cottons, silk & silk yarn, rice, sugar, etc.
- Import was small, but huge bullion (gold & silver) flowed into Bengal.
- Money circulation, prices and wages rose sharply.
- Foreign companies helped organise production on a large scale.

EUROPEAN TRADERS IN BENGAL

Portuguese

Early 16th century; major settlement at Hugli (1580).

Dutch

Early 17th century; factory near Hugli.

English

Early 17th century; moved to Calcutta.

French

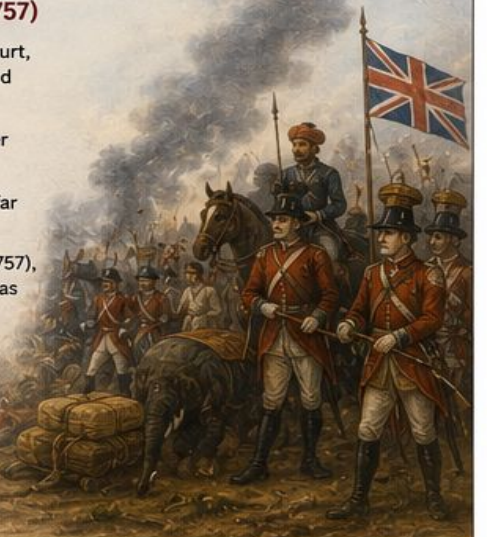
Later; factory at Chandernagar.

1698: With permission of Subahdar Azimuddin, English bought Sutanuti, Govindpur and Kolkata – foundation of Calcutta.



THE ROAD TO PLASSEY (1757)

- Internal rivalries in the Nawab's court, powerful bankers (Jagat Seths), and an assertive East India Company.
- Sirajuddaula attacked Calcutta over unauthorized fortification.
- Robert Clive conspired with Mir Jafar and other nobles.
- At the Battle of Plassey (23 June 1757), Siraj was defeated and Mir Jafar was installed as Nawab.
- Real Mughal authority in Bengal effectively ended.



From conquest to commerce – Bengal's wealth and changing politics shaped its destiny.



MAIN FEATURES OF THE ERA

- Rise of trade and commercial capitalism that drew many to Bengal
- Rise of Central Asian rule to its decline both in Delhi and Bengal
- Rise of independent Sultanates but dipped as feudalism declined and trade grew.
- Entry of colonial powers as traders, producers etc. supported by local commercial classes – English, Dutch, Portuguese.
- Final stage of Mughal rule ends with entry of British rule facilitated by a bankrupt Delhi

A WOMAN IN DHAKA CLAD IN FINE BENGALI MUSLIN, 18TH CENTURY.

SOCIO-ECONOMIC FEATURES

Mix of cultures continued as T-A rulers promoted local culture to gain more support to balance threat from Delhi

Mixing led to syncretistic or mixed practices such as Baul culture. Also mix of local animist beliefs and Aryan beliefs which coincided with rise of indigenous trading groups, Mongol Kabbya

Persian and Shia culture grew with TA dominance. Persian continued as language of courts into British period

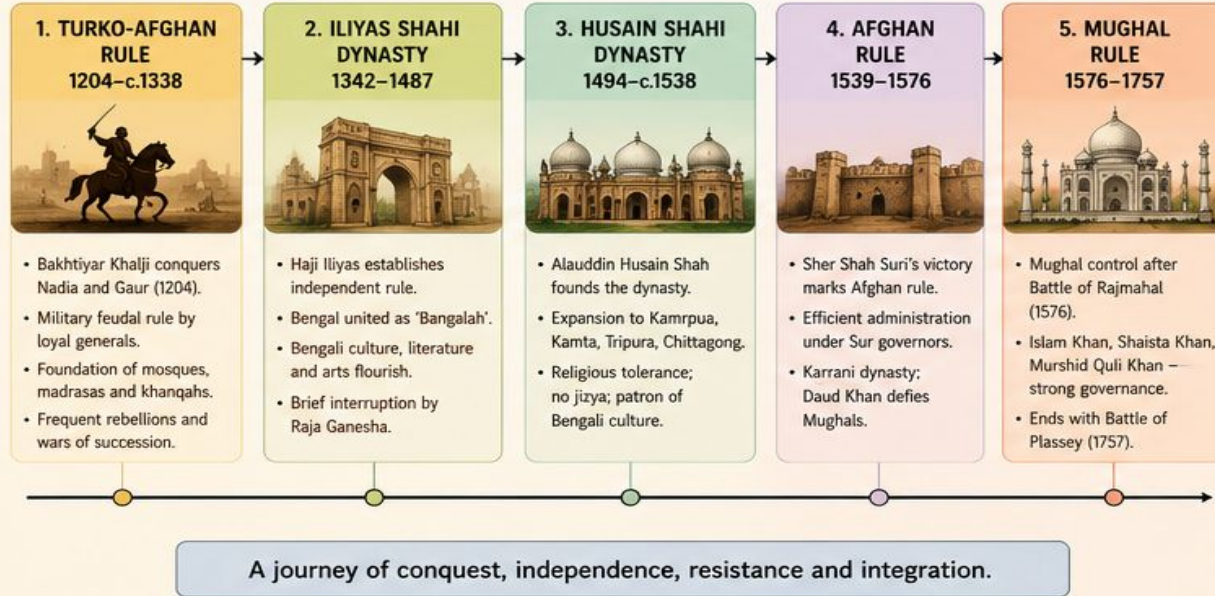
Sharing of administrative jobs between Hindus and Muslims

Local and colonial traders cooperated as trade increase and economy became monetized

Rise of manufacturing and markets.

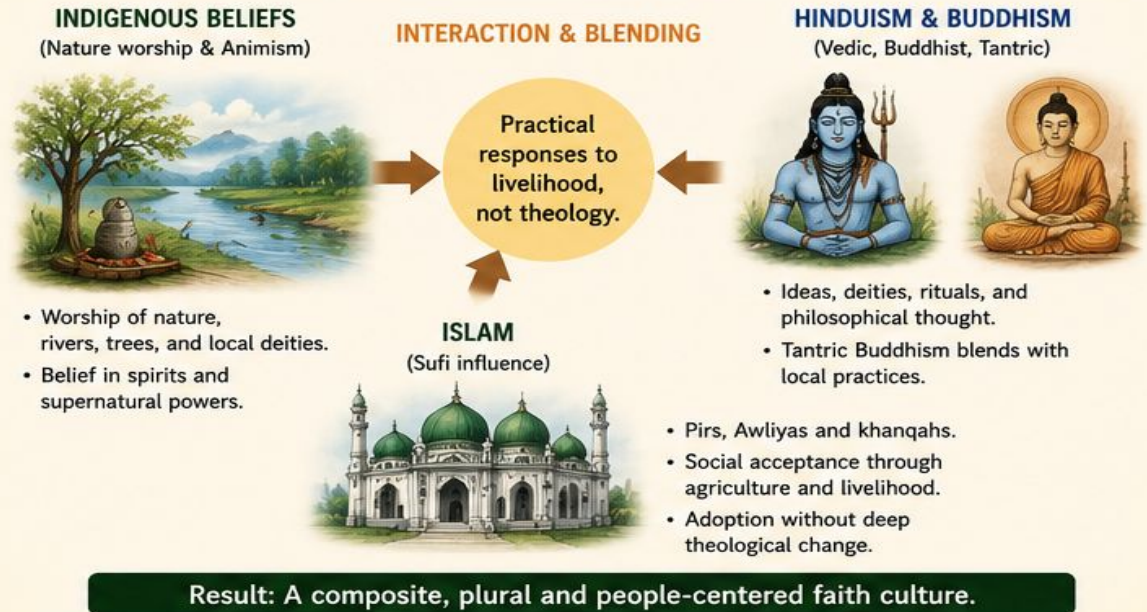


CHANGING RULES IN BENGAL (1204–1757)



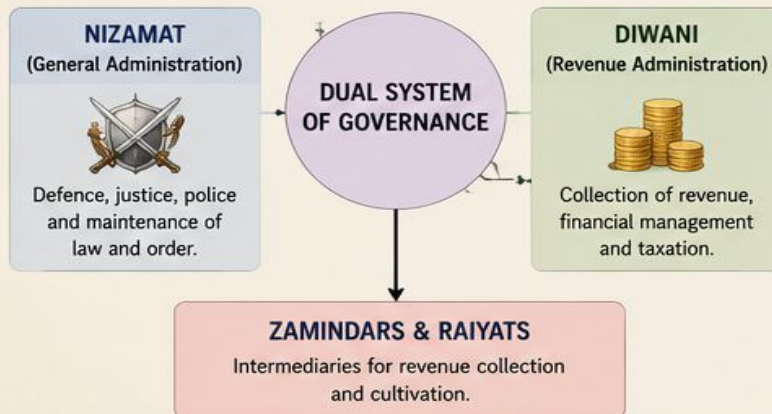
SYNCRETISM: THE BENGALI WAY OF FAITH

Bengal's faith and practices evolved through the blending of many traditions.



ECONOMY, ADMINISTRATION & THE ROAD TO PLASSEY (1576–1757)

MUGHAL ADMINISTRATION IN BENGAL



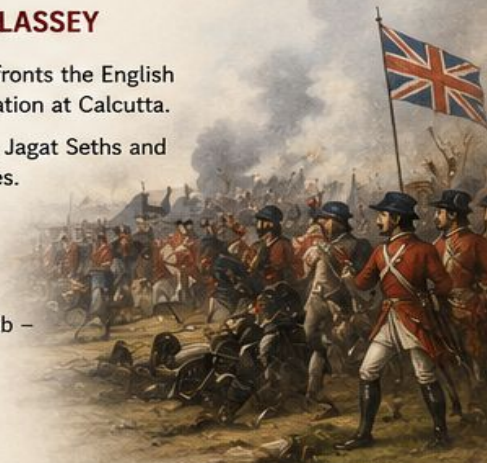
RIISING PROSPERITY



- Bengal becomes one of the wealthiest provinces.
- Growth of agriculture, handicrafts (silk, muslin), and overseas trade.
- Arrival of Europeans – Portuguese, Dutch, French, English.
- Rise of powerful banking families like Jagat Seth.

THE ROAD TO PLASSEY

- Nawab Sirajuddaula confronts the English for unauthorized fortification at Calcutta.
- Conspiracy by Mir Jafar, Jagat Seths and other discontented nobles.
- Battle of Plassey (23 June 1757): betrayal leads to Siraj's defeat.
- Mir Jafar becomes Nawab – real power shifts to the East India Company.



From military conquest to commercial wealth – Bengal's journey ends with the beginning of British power.

